

PRESS KIT

INKTENEBRIS

Dark Surreal Ballpoint Art

Official Press Kit

Artist: Soumalya Sarkar

Instagram: https://www.instagram.com/inktenebris_art

Website: <https://inktenebris.github.io>

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ARTIST OVERVIEW

INKTENEBRIS is the artistic practice of Soumalya Sarkar, an independent dark surreal artist working primarily with ballpoint pen. The project explores psychological horror, identity, transformation, memory, isolation, and the subconscious through monochromatic drawings constructed entirely by hand.

Using thousands of deliberate pen marks, the work creates symbolic narratives that exist between dream imagery and reality. Human figures become distorted, familiar forms are transformed, and hidden emotional states are visualized through darkness and contrast.

The practice focuses on creating artwork that invites interpretation rather than explanation. Each drawing functions as an open-ended visual experience, allowing viewers to engage with their own associations and meanings.

ARTISTIC THEMES

Identity

Exploring fragmented and changing perceptions of self.

Transformation

Visualizing physical and psychological change.

Memory

Investigating how memories evolve, distort, and persist.

Psychological Horror

Creating tension through suggestion, symbolism, and ambiguity.

Isolation

Examining emotional distance and internal experiences.

Subconscious Imagery

Drawing inspiration from dreams, fears, and hidden thoughts.

ARTIST STATEMENT

INKTENEBRIS

INKTENEBRIS is an ongoing exploration of darkness, identity, memory, transformation, and the hidden structures of the subconscious.

Working exclusively with ballpoint pen, I create monochromatic drawings through thousands of deliberate marks and layers of ink. The process is slow, demanding, and irreversible. Every line remains visible, every decision becomes permanent, and every image gradually emerges from darkness through patience and repetition.

My work is influenced by psychological horror, dream imagery, isolation, distorted perception, and the fragile relationship between reality and imagination. Human forms dissolve into unfamiliar shapes, familiar objects become unsettling, and ordinary experiences transform into symbolic narratives that exist beyond direct explanation.

Rather than presenting clear answers, these drawings invite interpretation. The imagery is intentionally open-ended, allowing viewers to project their own experiences, fears, memories, and emotions onto the work. The goal is not to dictate meaning but to create a space where meaning can emerge through personal reflection.

Many of the figures that appear throughout INKTENEBRIS exist in states of transformation. They are suspended between identities, between memory and forgetting, between beauty and discomfort. These visual ambiguities reflect the uncertainty that often exists beneath everyday perception.

The choice of ballpoint pen is central to the practice. Unlike many traditional art materials, ballpoint pen allows no erasure. Every mark contributes to the final image. This permanence mirrors the accumulation of memories, experiences, and emotions that shape personal identity over time.

Through INKTENEBRIS, I seek to create artwork that lingers beyond the moment it is seen. The drawings are intended to provoke curiosity, unease, introspection, and imagination. They invite viewers to enter unfamiliar spaces where darkness becomes a source of discovery rather than something to avoid.

Ultimately, the work exists between observation and interpretation. It embraces mystery, ambiguity, and transformation while remaining open to individual meaning. Each drawing becomes both a personal exploration and an invitation for others to confront the unknown within themselves.

SELECTED WORKS

THE HOLLOW ONE

A surreal exploration of curiosity, transformation, and the unknown.

METAMORPHOSIS

A psychological portrait depicting emotional decay and changing identity.

THE OBSERVER

An unsettling study of perception and silent presence.

SMILE WITHOUT EYES

A portrait suspended between familiarity and dread.

UNHINGED

An examination of emotional collapse and distorted anatomy.

THE HAND THAT SEES

A surreal fusion of touch, awareness, and perception.

THE CLOWN BELOW

A distorted figure balancing absurdity and psychological tension.

SEWN FLESH

An exploration of trauma, repair, and survival.

WATCHER

A silent presence emerging from darkness.

ARTIST INFORMATION

Artist Name: Soumalya Sarkar

Professional Name: INKTENEBRIS

Location: India

Medium: Ballpoint Pen on Paper

Genre: Dark Surrealism

Practice: Independent Artist

EXHIBITIONS

Current projects are being prepared for future exhibition opportunities and public presentations.

MEDIA & PRESS

Articles, interviews, publications, reviews, and media appearances related to INKTENEBRIS will be listed as they become available.

For interviews, publications, media requests, collaborations, or exhibition opportunities, please contact:

Email: soumalyasarkar61@gmail.com

CONTACT

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